

Improving Bengaluru Metro QR Ticket Experience

Overview

Project Type: UX Case Study (Concept Redesign)

Platform: Mobile – Namma Metro Digital Tickets

Role: UX Researcher & UI Designer

Tools: Figma

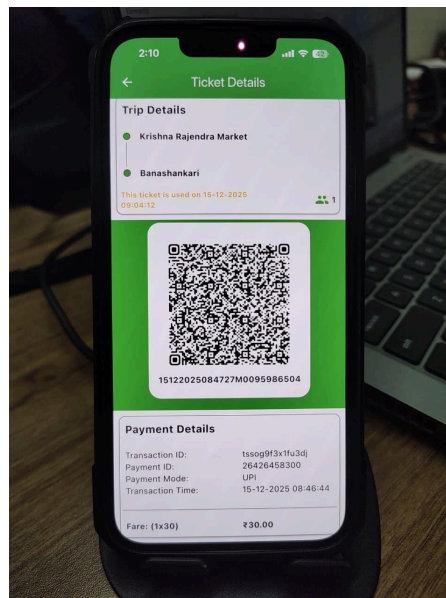
This project focuses on improving the **post-ticket purchase experience** for Bengaluru Metro QR tickets by adding essential journey guidance without altering the existing ticketing system.

Problem Statement

After purchasing a Bengaluru Metro QR ticket (via Namma Metro app, Paytm, or WhatsApp), users receive only a QR code with source and destination.

While this enables entry and exit, it **does not help users navigate the journey itself**.

A ticket that allows entry is not the same as a ticket that guides the journey.



Current Experience (Before)

What users see:

- QR code for entry & exit
- Source and destination stations
- Payment details

What's missing:

- Platform number
- Line color information
- Direction of travel
- Interchange stations

This lack of information causes confusion, especially for first-time users and during peak hours.

Users & Context

Primary Users

- First-time metro commuters
- Tourists and occasional travelers
- Daily commuters during rush hours

Common Scenarios

- Unsure which platform to choose
- Anxiety around interchange stations
- Hesitation after entering the station
- Dependence on staff or fellow passengers

Design Goal

To make metro travel **clear, confident, and stress-free** after ticket purchase by:

- Reducing confusion inside stations
- Providing immediate journey clarity
- Supporting decision-making in under 5 seconds
- Keeping the UI simple and offline-friendly

Design Approach

Instead of redesigning the entire app, this solution:

- Enhances the existing ticket UI
- Improves information hierarchy
- Adds contextual guidance only where needed
- Keeps QR code as the primary focus

The goal was to **layer guidance over the ticket**, not replace it.

Solution 1: Same-Line Journey Enhancement

Key Additions

Line Color Badge

Clearly indicates the metro line using color + text for accessibility.

Direction of Travel

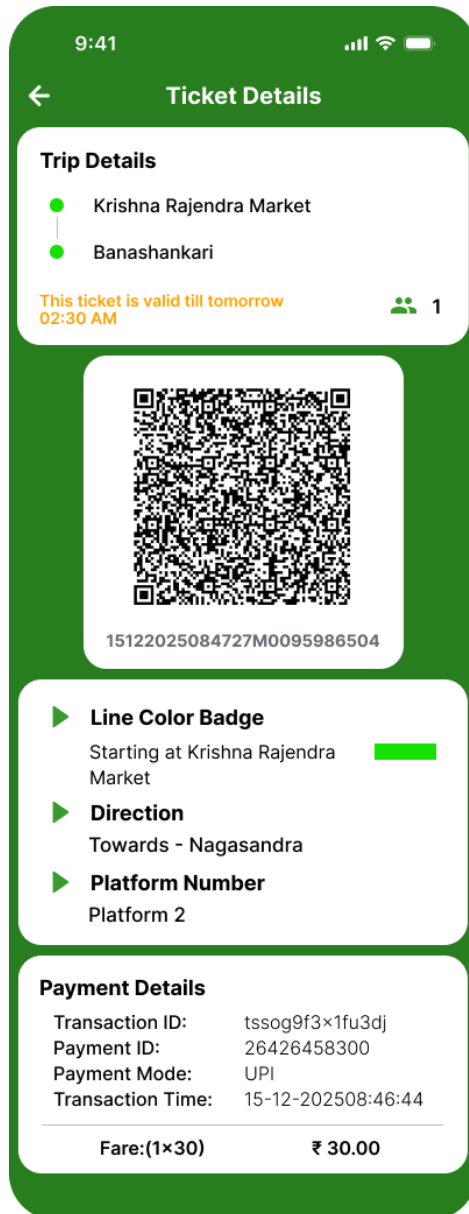
Shows terminal direction (e.g., *Towards Nagasandra*) to remove ambiguity.

Platform Number

Allows users to directly reach the correct platform without hesitation.

Outcome

- Faster movement inside stations
- Reduced confusion at platform entry
- Increased confidence for first-time users



Solution 2: Multi-Line / Interchange Journey

Interchanges are the most stressful part of metro travel.

Key Additions

Step-by-Step Line Flow

- Starting line clearly highlighted
- Interchange stations listed in order

- Visual line color transitions

Clear Interchange Guidance

Explicit instructions such as:

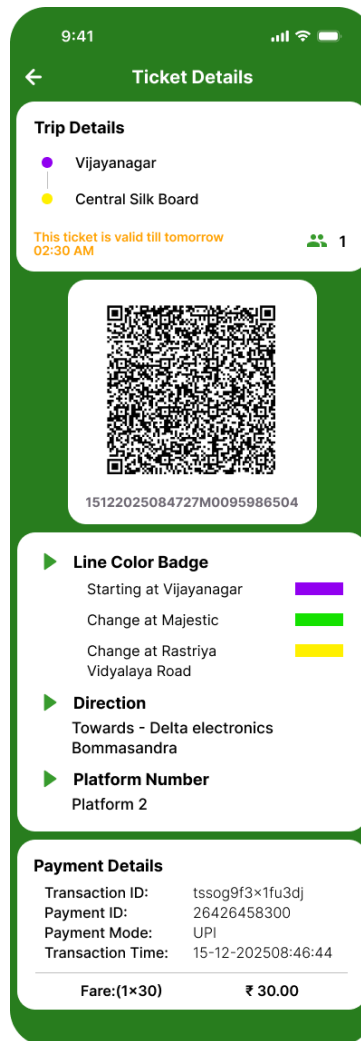
- Change at Majestic
- Change at Rashtiya Vidyalaya Road

Post-Interchange Direction

Final terminal direction and platform number retained.

Outcome

- Reduced fear of missing stations
- Less dependency on station staff
- Smoother experience for tourists



Information Hierarchy

The redesigned UI prioritizes user questions in real time:

1. Where should I go now? → Platform & direction
2. Which line am I on? → Line color badge
3. Do I need to change lines? → Interchange flow
4. Can I still enter/exit? → QR code remains central

This aligns with commuter behavior under time pressure.

Expected Impact

User Impact

- Reduced anxiety
- Faster station navigation
- Better first-time metro experience

System Impact

- Less crowding near help desks
 - Fewer wrong platform entries
 - Improved trust in digital ticketing
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Key Learnings

- UX does not end at payment success
 - Public transport design must support stressful moments
 - Small clarity improvements can create large impact
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Final Note

This case study demonstrates how **small, thoughtful UX enhancements** can make everyday public transport more humane and intuitive — without changing the core infrastructure.